LAYOUT REVIEW · DRAFT 1 · 16 OCT 2026

midnight-lite.com v2

A site for your projects (portfolio), a YouTube channel and build logs, with a discussion space. This PDF shows every page so you can circle, cross out and comment.

How to review

1. Each page of this PDF is one page of the site, shown at desktop width. There's a notes column on the right for handwriting.
2. Every section has a pink tag (`H1`, `P3`…). Refer to it in comments, e.g. *"H4: no newsletter, just YouTube subscribe"*.
3. Pink boxes explain what a section is for, or ask you something. They won't be on the real site.
4. **Text in [brackets]** and grey "photo" boxes are placeholders. Layout and structure matter now; wording and pictures come later.
5. The decisions page (page 3) has check boxes: tick one per question or write your own answer.

What's in this draft

PDF page	Site page	Tags
4	Home	NAV, H1–H7, FOOT
5	Projects (portfolio)	P1–P3
6	Project page (case study template)	D1–D7
7	Videos (YouTube channel hub)	V1–V3
8	Build log (blog list)	B1–B4
9	Build log post (with discussion)	A1–A4
10	About (skills, timeline, gear)	AB1–AB3
11	Tools (was "Services")	T1–T2
12	Community & contact	C1–C3
13	Home on a phone + dark mode	

Live preview on the home network: http://192.168.1.196:8091/next/ (add `?review` to see the tags). The current live site isn't changed.

NOTES

PAGE 2

Site map: old → new

Same brand and spirit, re-centred on three things: **projects** (portfolio), **videos** (YouTube) and **build logs** (blog), joined up by **discussion**.

Today	New	What changes
Home (hero, carousel)	**Home**	Clear pitch, "now making" strip, latest video, featured projects, latest posts, community call-out.
Projects + project1–3.html	**Projects** + one **project page** template	Filter by topic, status badges; every project gets the same case-study layout (story, timeline, files, discussion). Old URLs redirect.
(none)	**Videos**	New. Channel hub that fills itself from YouTube; series = playlists.
Dev Log (progress.html)	**Build log** + post pages	Becomes a real blog: posts per project, series, RSS, comments. Site updates become one category.
About	**About**	Portfolio-style: skills, timeline, gear.
Services (app launcher)	**Tools**	Renamed; EUC visualiser kept as-is.
Contact (footer only)	**Community**	Discussions, optional chat, video suggestions, contact form. Fake phone/LinkedIn removed.
404 / under construction	Kept	Restyled to match.

Navigation

Home · Projects · Videos · Build log · Tools · About · Community · ▶ YouTube

On phones these fold into a Menu button. Footer repeats the links plus socials, email and RSS.

How things connect

Video ⇄ Project page ⇄ Build log posts. Each project page lists its videos and posts; each video and post links back to its project. Comments sit on project pages and posts.

NOTES

PAGE 3

Decisions for you

Tick one per question (or write your own). Blue = my recommendation.

1. Discussion / comments system

☐ **Giscus**: free, comments stored in GitHub Discussions on your repo, people sign in with GitHub, you moderate in GitHub. Best fit for a maker audience; no server to run.
☐ Discord server: chat-style community, not on the page itself; needs moderating.
☐ Self-hosted comments on the NUC (e.g. Remark42): you own the data, but it means exposing the home server to the internet.
☐ YouTube comments only, no discussion on the site.

2. How the site is built

☐ **Astro (static site generator)**: posts and projects written in Markdown, RSS and YouTube feed built in, still plain fast pages on Netlify. Same tool as the MDC site.
☐ Keep hand-written HTML pages (every post is a new HTML file).

3. Email newsletter

☐ Yes (e.g. Buttondown, free tier) ☐ **Not yet**, just "Subscribe on YouTube" + RSS

4. How you appear

☐ Real name + photo ☐ Handle + photo ☐ **Handle + logo** (faceless for now)

Handle / channel name: _____ YouTube URL (if any): _____

@midnightlite

5. Which projects go public, in what order?

Ferrofluid ☐ ESP32 cam ☐ Rainforest photos ☐ USB-C board ☐ EUC visualiser ☐ This website ☐ Raspberry Pi ☐ Other: _____

& can you do documentation at page change into first blog post.

6. Contact email

☐ Keep enquiry@midnight-lite.com ☐ Other: _____

7. Anything to drop or add?

Pages/sections you don't want (e.g. Tools, Chat), or want added (e.g. shop, sponsors, gear list with affiliate links):

_____ nope. _____

NOTES

NAV

Midnight Lite

Home | Projects | Videos | Build log | Tools | About | Community | ▶ YouTube

H1

3D PRINTING · ROBOTS · PHOTOGRAPHY · ELECTRIC STUFF

I build things after dark.

Circuits, robots, prints and photos: the whole messy process, from the first sketch to the thing that finally works. Watch the videos, read the build logs, steal the files.

▶ Watch on YouTube | See the projects | Join the discussion

Midnight Lite

H1 hero. Headline + one-line pitch + 3 actions (video, projects, community). Replace the headline with your own voice; the logo stays big on the right (moves above the text on phones).

H2

NOW MAKING **Ferrofluid display add-on** · coil driver board, layout stage — 60%

H2 "Now making" strip. One line you update by hand (or later automatically from Forgejo's `wip` topic). Shows people the channel is alive between videos.

H3

What you'll find here

3D printing
Functional prints, print profiles and the failures that taught me something.

Robots
Motors, sensors and firmware, built up one revision at a time.

Photography
Shots, gear notes and DIY rigs for getting the picture.

Electric stuff
KiCad boards with schematics, datasheets, BOMs and the maths behind them.

H3 topics. The four pillars from your logo. Each opens the Projects page pre-filtered. Keep, rename or add a fifth (e.g. "Web & software")?

H4

Latest video · YouTube embed goes here

LATEST VIDEO

Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

The idea, the magnets, and the first board that didn't work. 12 min.

▶ Watch | Read the build log

Don't miss the next one

New videos and build logs, about twice a month. No spam.

you@example.com | Subscribe

H4 latest video + subscribe. Pulls the newest upload from your channel automatically (YouTube embed) once it exists. The email box is optional: decide if you want a newsletter (e.g. Buttondown) or just "Subscribe on YouTube".

H5

Featured projects

All projects →

BOARD RENDER

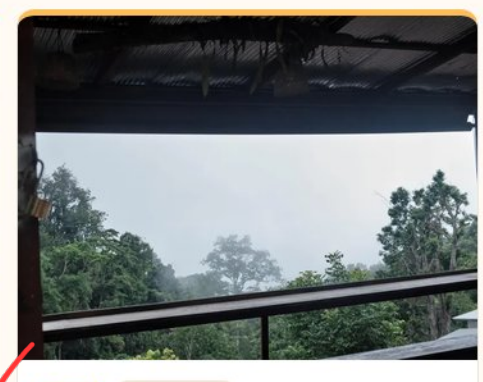
IN PROGRESS · Electric · KiCad

Ferrofluid display add-on
An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music.

CAMERA PHOTO

IN PROGRESS · Electric · ESP32

ESP32 cam for fun
A DIY Wi-Fi camera that streams live video for home monitoring, because why not.



DONE · Photography

Rainforest mornings
A photo set from the hills: fog, green and a lot of waiting.

H5 featured projects. You pick 3 to feature. Each card: status, topics, one line. Real project photos/renders replace the placeholders.

H6

From the build log

All posts →

12 OCT 2026 · ELECTRIC

Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself
MOSFETs, flyback diodes and the maths for how warm it gets.

6 min read · 4 comments

2 OCT 2026 · WEB

Rebuilding this website (again)
Why the site now centres on videos and build logs.

4 min read · 2 comments

20 SEP 2026 · ELECTRIC

My first USB-C board
Two 5.1k resistors that make a charger actually give you 5 V.

5 min read · 7 comments

H6 build log. Written posts that go with (or between) videos. Comment counts come from the discussion system you choose (see Community page).

H7

Building something similar?

Ask questions, share your build, or suggest the next video. Every project page has its own discussion.

Go to the community | Email me

H7 community call-out. Funnels people into discussion. The real phone number / LinkedIn placeholders from the old footer are removed.

FOOT

Midnight Lite

3D printing, robots, photography and electric stuff. Built in the open, documented as I go.

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NOTES

Change to Great ideas comes at night. or similar.

is there a easy way to update this.

Replace with Website.

I think Good start here.

NAV

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Home | Projects | Videos | Build log | Tools | About | Community | ▶ YouTube

P1

PORTFOLIO

Projects

Everything I've built or am building, with the files, the notes and what went wrong.
Pick a topic or just scroll.

P1 intro. Short and personal. This page doubles as your skills portfolio, so each card links to a full case study.

P2

All | 3D printing | Robots | Photography | Electric | Web & software

Search projects...

P2 filters. Topic chips + search. Statuses: *In progress* (blue), *Done* (amber), *Coming soon* (grey).

P3

BOARD RENDER

IN PROGRESS · Electric · KiCad

Ferrofluid display add-on

An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music.

▶ 1 video · 3 build logs · updated 4 days ago

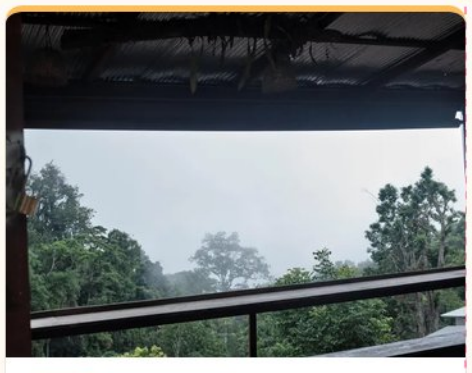
CAMERA PHOTO

IN PROGRESS · Electric · ESP32

ESP32 cam for fun

A DIY Wi-Fi surveillance camera that streams live video, because why not.

2 build logs · updated 3 weeks ago



DONE · Photography

Rainforest mornings

A photo set from the hills: fog, green and a lot of waiting.

12 photos

PCB PHOTO

DONE · Electric · KiCad

USB-C LED test board

My first USB-C power board: the two resistors that make chargers behave.

1 build log · files on GitHub

APP SCREENSHOT

LIVE · Web & software · React

EUC World data visualiser

Upload an EUC World ride log and see the map, speed and battery charts.

Try it in Tools →

SITE SCREENSHOT

IN PROGRESS · Web & software

This website

Built from scratch, rebuilt more than once. The dev log lives here too.

Dev log →

COMING SOON

COMING SOON · Robots · Raspberry Pi

Raspberry Pi project

Details soon. Something fun and probably slightly over-engineered.

PRINT PHOTO

COMING SOON · 3D printing

[Your first print project]

Placeholder: the first 3D printing project you want to show.

P3 project grid. Your real projects from the old site plus the KiCad work. Which ones should be public, and in what order? Each card shows status, topics, and how much content it has (videos/logs).

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D1

PROJECTS / ELECTRIC

Ferrofluid display add-on

An electromagnet driver board that makes ferrofluid dance to music. *[placeholder text: your one-paragraph summary]*

▶ Watch the video | Get the files | Discuss

D1 project header. The case-study template every project uses. Title, one-paragraph summary, 3 quick actions.

D2

HERO PHOTO OR 3D BOARD RENDER

D2 hero image. Best photo/render. Click opens a gallery (your old lightbox.js can be reused).

D3

Why I built it

[Placeholder] The idea, the inspiration, what problem it solves or why it's fun. Two or three short paragraphs in your own words.

How it works

[Placeholder] A plain-English explanation with one diagram: audio in → analyser → coil driver → electromagnets → ferrofluid.

BLOCK DIAGRAM

The build

[Placeholder] Key decisions and the maths, pulled from the project's `DESIGN.md` : coil current, MOSFET choice, heat. Link to the full build logs below.

> **What went wrong:** [placeholder] the honest bit people love: the mistake and how it was fixed.

Result

[Placeholder] Photos/video of it working, what you'd change next time.

D3 story. Fixed structure (Why / How / Build / What went wrong / Result) makes projects quick to write up and easy to read. Content can be copied from the KiCad `DESIGN.md` files.

D4

Build logs & videos

12 Oct 2026
Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

5 Oct 2026
▶ Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

28 Sep 2026
First schematic and the parts list

D4 timeline. Every post/video tagged with this project shows up here automatically, newest first.

D5

Files

Schematic (PDF)
Exported from KiCad.

BOM (Excel)
Parts, suppliers, datasheets.

Gerbers
Ready for JLCPCB / PCBWay.

Source on GitHub
Firmware + KiCad project.

D5 files. Optional per project. KiCad exports (schematic PDF, BOM .xlsx, Gerbers) already come out of the NUC's kicad-docs tool. Public only for projects you choose to open-source.

D6

Discussion

JS **jsmith** · 2 days ago
What MOSFET are you using for the coils? Mine get hot at 2 A.

ML **Midnight Lite** author · 1 day ago
An IRLZ44N with a heatsink. The full maths is in the build log!

Ask a question or share your build...

Post comment | Sign in with GitHub to comment.

D6 discussion. Comments per project/post. **Decision needed** (see the decisions page): Giscus (free, GitHub sign-in, stored in GitHub Discussions), Discord, or a self-hosted system.

D7

At a glance

Status	IN PROGRESS
Started	Sep 2026
Topics	Electric · KiCad
Skills	PCB design, power electronics
Tools	KiCad 10, ESP32
Cost	~$[placeholder]

On this page

Why I built it
How it works
The build
Result
Build logs & videos
Files
Discussion

D7 sidebar. "At a glance" facts make it work as a portfolio piece (skills, tools). Sticks while scrolling on desktop; moves to the top on phones.

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V1

YOUTUBE CHANNEL

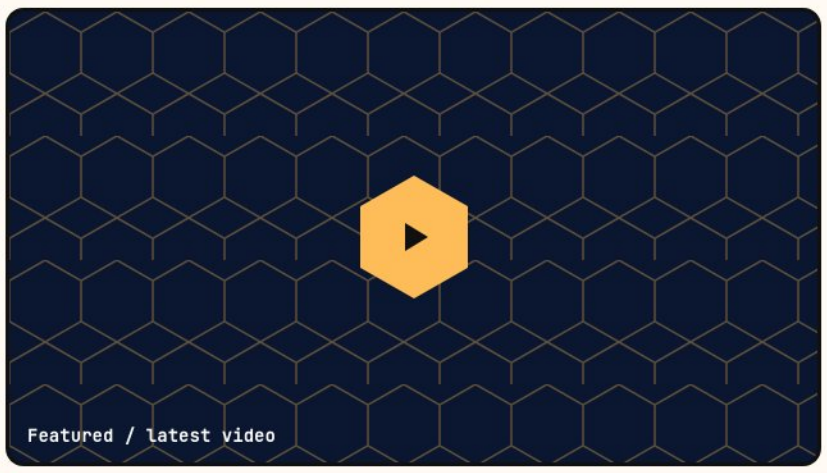
Videos

▶ Subscribe on YouTube

Build videos, quick tips and the occasional disaster. New episodes about twice a month.

V1 channel header. Links to the channel. Once the channel exists, this page fills itself from the channel's feed (no manual updates).

V2



NEW

Ep. 1: Why I'm building a ferrofluid display

The idea, the magnets, and the first board that didn't work.

Chapters: 0:00 Intro · 1:20 How ferrofluid moves · 4:05 The driver board · 9:40 First test

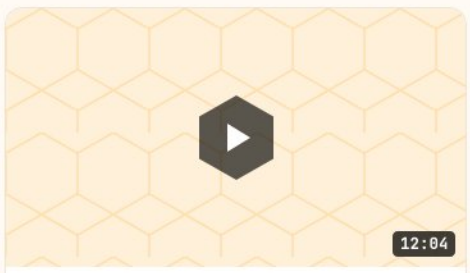
Project page | Build log

V2 featured video. The newest (or a pinned) video with chapters and links to its project page and build log. Videos and projects link both ways.

V3

Series

All | Ferrofluid display | Quick tips | Photography walks | Shorts



FERROFLUID DISPLAY · EP. 1

Why I'm building a ferrofluid display



FERROFLUID DISPLAY · EP. 2

[Planned] Driving the coils



QUICK TIPS · SHORT

[Planned] USB-C in 60 seconds: the 5.1k trick



PHOTOGRAPHY WALKS

[Planned] Rainforest in the fog with the X100



ROBOTS

[Planned] ESP32 camera, part 1



3D PRINTING

[Planned] Printing the enclosure

V3 series grid. Videos grouped by series (= YouTube playlists). [Planned] ones show what's coming. Is a "Shorts" row worth having?

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B1

BLOG

Build log

Written notes from the bench: progress, the maths, the mistakes. Shorter than a video, more detail than a caption.

B1 intro. Named "Build log" rather than "Blog" to fit the maker theme (and it absorbs the old Dev Log page). Rename if you prefer.

B2

All | Electric | Robots | 3D printing | Photography | Web | Site updates

B2 filters. Same topics as projects, plus "Site updates" (the old changelog).

B3

COVER IMAGE

12 OCT 2026 · ELECTRIC · FERROFLUID DISPLAY

Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

MOSFETs, flyback diodes and the maths for how warm it gets, with a spreadsheet you can reuse.

6 min read · 4 comments · ▶ has video

2 OCT 2026 · SITE UPDATES

Rebuilding this website (again)

Why the site now centres on videos and build logs, and what moved where.

4 min read · 2 comments

28 SEP 2026 · ELECTRIC · FERROFLUID DISPLAY

First schematic and the parts list

From napkin sketch to a KiCad schematic, plus where the datasheets live.

7 min read · 1 comment

20 SEP 2026 · ELECTRIC

My first USB-C board

Two 5.1k resistors that make a charger actually give you 5 V.

5 min read · 7 comments

B3 post list. Newest first; the top post is bigger. Posts tagged with a project also appear on that project's page.

B4

Search

Search posts...

Series

Ferrofluid display (3)
Website rebuild (2)
ESP32 cam (2)

Get new posts

By email or RSS.

Subscribe | RSS

B4 sidebar. Search, series, subscribe/ RSS.

FOOT

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A1

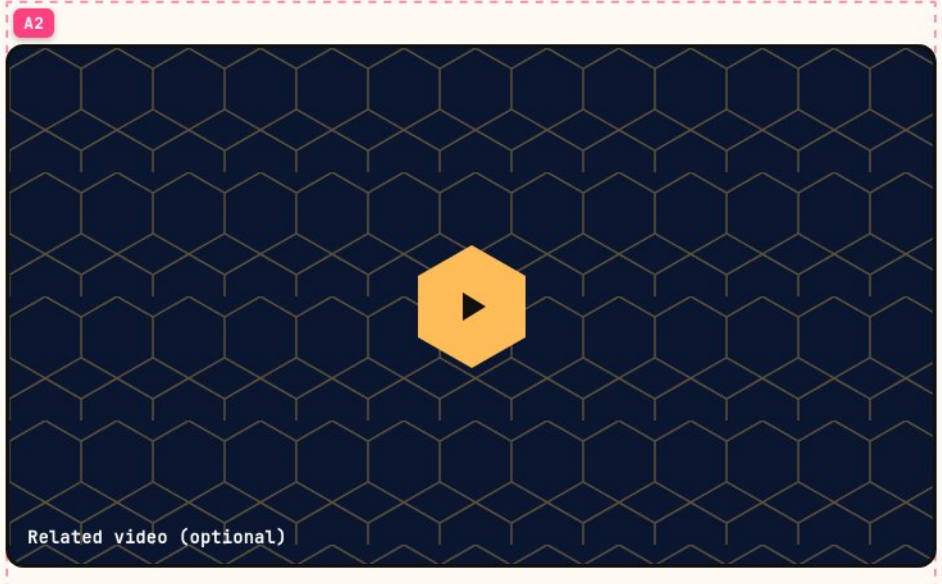
BUILD LOG · ELECTRIC · FERROFLUID DISPLAY

Picking a coil driver that won't cook itself

12 Oct 2026 · 6 min read · by Midnight Lite

A1 post header. Title, date, reading time, and which project/series it belongs to.

A2



Related video (optional)

[Placeholder] Intro paragraph: what this post is about and what you'll learn.

The problem

[Placeholder] Each electromagnet pulls about 1.5 A. Switch that fast with the wrong part and it gets hot quickly.

The maths

[Placeholder] Power lost in the MOSFET: $P = I^2 \times R_{DS(on)} = 1.5^2 \times 0.035 = 0.08\ W$. Easily fine without a heatsink.

SCOPE CAPTURE / PHOTO

> Tip: [placeholder] always add the flyback diode. Ask me how I know.

What's next

[Placeholder] Link to the next post or video in the series.

A2 article. Readable width, code/maths styling, images, optional video embed at the top. Written in Markdown later (no HTML needed for new posts).

A3

← Previous: First schematic and the parts list

Next: [coming soon] →

A3 series navigation. Previous / next within the same project or series.

A4

Discussion (4)

KT **kt_builds** · 3 days ago
Would a logic-level MOSFET work straight from the ESP32 pins?

ML **Midnight Lite** author · 3 days ago
Yes, at 3.3 V gate drive the IRLZ44N is fine for this current. I'll show it in Ep. 2.

Join the discussion...

Post comment

A4 discussion. Same comment system as project pages. You get notified, can reply as the author, and moderate.

FOOT

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AB1

ABOUT

Hi, I'm [your name or handle].

I make circuits, robots, prints and photos, mostly late at night. Midnight Lite is where I share the whole process so others can learn from it (and from my mistakes).

See my work | Get in touch

YOUR PHOTO

AB1 intro. Your name or just a handle? Photo in a hexagon, or the logo instead if you'd rather stay faceless.

AB2

Skills

Electronics
PCB design (KiCad), power & USB-C, ESP32, Raspberry Pi, soldering.

Software
Python, JavaScript/React, embedded C, home-server tinkering.

Making
3D printing, CAD, enclosures, robotics.

Photography
Fujifilm X100, landscapes and travel, editing.

AB2 skills. This is what makes it a portfolio. Edit to your real skill list; each could link to the projects that prove it.

AB3

Timeline

2026
Launching the YouTube channel and build log.

2026
First custom PCBs: USB-C power, ferrofluid driver.

2025
Built this website from scratch; EUC World visualiser.

[year]
[Placeholder: study / work milestone]

Gear I use

Camera	Fujifilm X100 [model]
Printer	[placeholder]
PCB design	KiCad 10
Microcontrollers	ESP32, Raspberry Pi
Home lab	Self-hosted server, NAS

AB3 timeline + gear. Viewers always ask "what camera/printer is that?". Gear can later use affiliate links if you want.

FOOT

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Put Logo for now.

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T1

FREE WEB TOOLS

Tools

Small apps I built for my own projects, free to use in your browser. Nothing you upload leaves your computer.

T1 intro. Replaces the old "Services" page (the name suggested paid services). Your existing EUC visualiser moves here unchanged.

T2

APP SCREENSHOT

LIVE · EUC · Maps & charts

EUC World data visualiser

Upload an EUC World ride log (CSV) to see your route on a map plus speed, battery and temperature charts.

IDEA

IDEA · Electric

[Idea] LED resistor calculator

Supply voltage + LED colour → resistor value and power, with the maths shown.

IDEA

IDEA · 3D printing

[Idea] Print cost estimator

Filament weight + price + power → what a print really costs.

T2 tools. Real tool + two ideas that would suit the channel (tools bring search traffic). Keep, drop or add your own ideas.

FOOT

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C1

COMMUNITY

Let's build together

Ask questions, show off your build, suggest the next video. Be kind, share what you learn.

C1 intro. Home of the "discussion space". House rules link here too.

C2

Discussions

Topic boards: Help, Show & tell, Video ideas, General. Every project and post also has its own thread.

Open discussions

Chat

[Optional] A Discord server for quick questions and live build nights.

Join the chat

Suggest a video

What should I build or explain next? Vote on ideas from other people.

Suggest & vote

C2 ways to take part. Decision needed: which discussion system (see decisions page). "Chat" is optional; drop it if you don't want to moderate a Discord.

C3

Recent discussions

KT **Help:** Logic-level MOSFET straight from ESP32?
kt_builds · 4 replies · 3 days ago

RB **Show & tell:** My ferrofluid speaker, inspired by Ep. 1
robo_bec · 9 replies · 5 days ago

JS **Video ideas:** Can you do a KiCad beginner series?
jsmith · 12 votes · 1 week ago

Contact

For collaborations, sponsorships or anything private.

Your name

Email

Message

Send

Or email enquiry@midnight-lite.com

C3 recent threads + contact form. The form can use Netlify Forms (free on your current host, no server needed). The fake phone number and LinkedIn placeholders are gone.

FOOT

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▶ YouTube

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I build things after dark.

Circuits, robots, prints and photos: the whole messy process, from the first sketch to the thing that finally works. Watch the videos, read the build logs, steal the files.

▶ Watch on YouTube
See the projects
Join the discussion

NOW MAKING
Ferrofluid display add-on · coil driver board, layout stage
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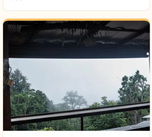
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